

Word family: **overwhelm / overwhelms / overwhelmed / overwhelming / overwhelmingly**

Base word: overwhelm

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **overwhelm** (v.) — 壓垮；使應付不來；使情緒淹沒；徹底擊敗

* **overwhelmed** (adj./participle) — 不勝負荷的；被壓得喘不過氣的；感動得不知所措的

* **overwhelming** (adj.) — 壓倒性的；難以承受的；極其強烈的

* **overwhelmingly** (adv.) — 壓倒性地；極其；以極大多數

* **overwhelm someone with something** — 用大量某物令某人應接不暇

* **be overwhelmed by / with** — 被.....壓得應付不來 / 被.....深深觸動

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **feel overwhelmed**

* **be overwhelmed by work**

* **be overwhelmed with emotion**

* **overwhelming pressure**

* **overwhelming evidence**

* **overwhelming majority**

* **overwhelming support**

* **overwhelm the system**

* **overwhelm the defence**

* **overwhelm someone with information**

* **overwhelmed with gratitude**

* **overwhelmed by grief**

* **overwhelmingly positive**

* **overwhelmingly likely**

Meaning in this passage

> ...when I was constantly **overwhelmed by deadlines, group projects, and part-time work**.

Here, **overwhelmed** means:

feeling that there was too much to deal with and not enough mental or practical capacity to cope — 被壓得喘不過氣；應付不來；不勝負荷

The speaker had too many deadlines, projects, and work demands at once, so they felt mentally overloaded.

中文翻譯：

當時我經常被截止日期、小組功課和兼職工作**壓得喘不過氣來 / 應付不來**。

So here:

be overwhelmed by X = X 的數量、壓力或強度太大，令某人覺得無法好好應付

1. **overwhelm someone (使不勝負荷) — 壓垮；令應付不來**

This is the core sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I was constantly **overwhelmed by deadlines and work**.

我經常被截止日期和工作**壓得喘不過氣來**。

Practice 2

> Too many tasks can **overwhelm students**.

太多任務可以令學生**應付不來**。

Practice 3

> The amount of work **overwhelmed me**.

工作量把我**壓得透不過氣**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelm someone = 令某人面對太多事情、壓力或刺激，以致難以應付****

2. **feel overwhelmed — 覺得不勝負荷**

Practice 1

> I **felt overwhelmed** by everything I had to do.

我要做的事情太多，令我**感到不勝負荷**。

Practice 2

> She started to **feel overwhelmed** during exam week.

考試周期間，她開始覺得**應付不來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel overwhelmed = 覺得事情太多或壓力太大，超出自己的應付能力

3. **be overwhelmed by work** — 被工作壓垮

Practice 1

> He was **overwhelmed by work**.

他被工作**壓得喘不過氣**。

Practice 2

> I don't want to become **overwhelmed by my workload** again.

我不想再次被工作量**壓得應付不來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be overwhelmed by work = 工作量太大，令人難以處理

4. **be overwhelmed with tasks / responsibilities** — 被任務 / 責任壓得應付不來

Practice 1

> She was **overwhelmed with responsibilities**.

她被各種責任**壓得透不過氣**。

Practice 2

> The team became **overwhelmed with tasks**.

團隊被大量任務弄得**應接不暇**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be overwhelmed with X = X 太多，以致某人無法有效處理

5. **overwhelm someone with information** — 資訊多得令某人應接不暇

Practice 1

> Don't **overwhelm the audience with too much information**.

不要用太多資訊把觀眾弄得**應接不暇**。

Practice 2

> The instructions **overwhelmed me with details**.

說明裏的細節多得令我**難以消化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelm someone with X = 一次提供太多 X，使人難以處理或吸收

6. **overwhelmed (被強烈情緒淹沒)** — 情緒非常強烈；感動得不知所措

A major emotional branch.

Practice 1

> She was **overwhelmed with gratitude**.

她感激得**不知如何表達**。

Practice 2

> He was **overwhelmed by grief**.

他被悲痛**淹沒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be overwhelmed by/with emotion = 情緒強烈到幾乎完全佔據某人的心理狀態

7. **overwhelmed with gratitude** — 感激萬分

Practice 1

> I was **overwhelmed with gratitude** for their support.

他們的支持令我**感激萬分**。

Practice 2

> She felt **overwhelmed with gratitude**.

她感到**非常感激**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelmed with gratitude = 感激之情極其強烈

8. **overwhelmed by grief / sadness — 被悲痛淹沒**

Practice 1

> He was **overwhelmed by grief** after the loss.

失去親人後，他被**悲痛淹沒**。

Practice 2

> She felt **overwhelmed by sadness**.

她感到極度**悲傷難受**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelmed by grief/sadness = 悲傷強烈到幾乎無法控制或處理

9. **overwhelm (徹底擊敗；壓制) — 壓倒；徹底擊敗**

A major separate verb sense.

Practice 1

> The stronger team **overwhelmed their opponents**.

較強的一隊**徹底壓制了對手**。

Practice 2

> The army was **overwhelmed** by a much larger force.

軍隊被規模大得多的敵軍****徹底壓倒****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelm an opponent = 以遠超對方的力量、數量或能力徹底壓制對方****

10. ****overwhelm the defence — 壓垮防守****

Practice 1

> Their speed ****overwhelmed the defence****.

他們的速度****壓垮了防守****。

Practice 2

> The attack ****overwhelmed the opposing team****.

攻勢****徹底壓制了對方球隊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelm a defence/opponent = 以強大攻勢令對方無力應對****

11. ****overwhelm a system / service — 令系統超出負荷****

A major technical/infrastructural use.

Practice 1

> Too many users ****overwhelmed the server****.

太多使用者令伺服器****超出負荷****。

Practice 2

> Heavy demand ****overwhelmed the service****.

龐大需求令服務系統****不勝負荷****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelm a system = 需求量太大，超過系統正常處理能力****

12. **overwhelm emergency services** — 令緊急服務超負荷

Practice 1

> The sudden increase in calls **overwhelmed emergency services**.

電話量突然增加，令緊急服務**超出負荷**。

Practice 2

> The hospital was **overwhelmed by patients**.

醫院因病人太多而**不勝負荷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelm a service = 使用需求太大，令服務無法正常處理

13. **overwhelming (壓倒性的；極強的)** — 壓倒性的；極其強烈的

A major adjective.

Practice 1

> The evidence was **overwhelming**.

證據**壓倒性地充分**。

Practice 2

> She felt **overwhelming relief**.

她感到**極大的如釋重負**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelming = 強烈、巨大或數量多到難以忽視或抵抗的

14. **overwhelming pressure** — 巨大壓力

Practice 1

> He was under **overwhelming pressure**.

他承受着**巨大的壓力**。

Practice 2

> The **overwhelming pressure** affected his judgment.

壓倒性的壓力影響了他的判斷。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelming pressure = 強烈到令人難以承受或正常應付的壓力

15. **overwhelming evidence — 壓倒性證據；極充分證據**

Practice 1

> There was **overwhelming evidence** that the file had already been uploaded.

有**極充分證據**顯示檔案早已上傳。

Practice 2

> The conclusion was supported by **overwhelming evidence**.

這個結論得到**壓倒性證據**支持。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelming evidence = 證據數量或強度大到幾乎不容合理質疑

16. **overwhelming majority — 壓倒性多數**

Practice 1

> An **overwhelming majority** supported the proposal.

壓倒性多數支持提案。

Practice 2

> The motion passed by an **overwhelming majority**.

動議以**大比數多數**通過。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelming majority = 數量上遠遠多於反對方的絕大多數****

17. ****overwhelming support — 壓倒性支持****

Practice 1

> The idea received ****overwhelming support****.

這個想法獲得****壓倒性支持****。

Practice 2

> There was ****overwhelming support**** for the change.

這項改變得****極大支持****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelming support = 支持程度非常高，遠多於反對****

18. ****overwhelming feeling / emotion — 強烈到難以承受的感受****

Practice 1

> I had an ****overwhelming feeling of relief****.

我有一種****極強烈的如釋重負感****。

Practice 2

> She felt an ****overwhelming sense of responsibility****.

她感到一股****極強烈的責任感****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****overwhelming feeling = 強烈到幾乎完全佔據注意力和情緒的感受****

19. ****overwhelmingly — 壓倒性地；極其****

Practice 1

> The feedback was **overwhelmingly positive**.

回饋**絕大多數都是正面的**。

Practice 2

> The audience was **overwhelmingly supportive**.

觀眾**壓倒性地支持**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelmingly = 以非常大比例或極強程度

20. **overwhelmingly positive / negative — 絕大多數正面 / 負面**

Practice 1

> The response was **overwhelmingly positive**.

反應**幾乎一面倒地正面**。

Practice 2

> Reviews were **overwhelmingly negative**.

評論**絕大多數都是負面的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelmingly positive/negative = 幾乎大多數意見都朝同一方向

21. **overwhelmingly likely — 極有可能**

Practice 1

> It is **overwhelmingly likely** that the delay was caused by a technical issue.

極有可能是技術問題造成延誤。

Practice 2

> The evidence makes that explanation **overwhelmingly likely**.

證據令那個解釋變得**極有可能**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overwhelmingly likely = 可能性非常高

Important distinction 1: **overwhelmed vs stressed**

stressed

under pressure.

overwhelmed

pressure is so great that you feel you **cannot cope properly**.

> stressed with work

> 工作有壓力

> overwhelmed by work

> 工作多到**應付不來**

So **overwhelmed** is usually stronger.

Important distinction 2: **overwhelmed vs busy**

busy

have many things to do.

overwhelmed

have more than you feel capable of handling.

You can be busy without being overwhelmed.

Important distinction 3: **overwhelmed vs exhausted**

****overwhelmed****

mental/practical overload.

****exhausted****

extreme tiredness.

In your passage, the speaker can be both:

* ****overwhelmed**** by demands,

* ****exhausted**** by the resulting workload.

Important distinction 4: ****overwhelmed vs frustrated****

****frustrated****

blocked or unable to make progress.

****overwhelmed****

too much to process or manage.

Different emotional mechanisms.

Important distinction 5: ****overwhelm with vs overwhelm by****

Both occur, with tendencies:

****overwhelmed by****

often emphasizes cause:

> overwhelmed by deadlines

****overwhelmed with****

often emphasizes what fills/surrounds someone:

> overwhelmed with work

> overwhelmed with gratitude

There is significant overlap.

Important distinction 6: ****overwhelmed can be positive or negative****

Negative:

- > overwhelmed by deadlines
- > 被工作壓垮

Positive:

- > overwhelmed with gratitude
- > 感激得不知所措

So the word itself means ****too strong/much to process easily****, not automatically “bad.”

Important distinction 7: ****overwhelming vs overwhelming someone****

Adjective:

- > overwhelming pressure

巨大壓力

Verb:

- > pressure overwhelmed me

壓力把我壓垮

Same family, different grammar.

Important distinction 8: ****overwhelming majority does not mean emotional overwhelm****

It means:

****數量上極大、幾乎一面倒****

This is a quantitative extension.

Important distinction 9: **overwhelm a system vs break a system**

overwhelm

demand exceeds capacity.

break

system stops functioning, for any reason.

A system can be overwhelmed temporarily without being permanently broken.

Important distinction 10: **overwhelming evidence vs conclusive evidence**

overwhelming evidence

very large/strong body of evidence.

conclusive evidence

sufficient to settle the question.

Overwhelming evidence is often conclusive, but the emphasis differs:

* **overwhelming** → amount/strength

* **conclusive** → finality

Important distinction 11: **overwhelmingly vs very**

very

simple degree.

overwhelmingly

either:

* by a very large majority,

* to an exceptionally strong degree.

> overwhelmingly positive

usually suggests the vast majority was positive, not merely “very positive.”

Family-extension note

Overwhelm has one powerful semantic core:

something is too strong, too large, or too much to resist or cope with normally

That branches into:

1. **mental/workload overload**

* overwhelmed by deadlines

* overwhelmed with tasks

2. **emotional intensity**

* overwhelmed with gratitude

* overwhelmed by grief

3. **defeat / physical force**

* overwhelm an opponent

4. **system capacity**

* overwhelm a server

* overwhelm emergency services

5. **extreme degree**

* overwhelming pressure

* overwhelming evidence

6. **large majority**

* overwhelming majority

* overwhelmingly positive

For your passage, the exact branch is:

too many demands at once → unable to cope comfortably

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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overwhelm someone	壓垮；令應付不來	exceed coping capacity	
feel overwhelmed	感到不勝負荷	mental overload	
overwhelmed by work	被工作壓得喘不過氣	workload	
overwhelmed with tasks	任務多得應接不暇	too many demands	
overwhelm with information	資訊多得難以消化	cognitive overload	
overwhelmed with gratitude	感激萬分	strong positive emotion	
overwhelmed by grief	被悲痛淹沒	strong negative emotion	
overwhelm an opponent	徹底擊敗 / 壓制	domination	
overwhelm a system	令系統超負荷	exceed capacity	
overwhelming	壓倒性的；極強的	extreme force/degree	
overwhelming pressure	巨大壓力	too much pressure	
overwhelming evidence	壓倒性證據	massive evidential support	
overwhelming majority	壓倒性多數	huge majority	
overwhelming support	壓倒性支持	very high support	
overwhelming feeling	極強烈感受	emotional intensity	
overwhelmingly	壓倒性地；極其	huge degree/proportion	
overwhelmingly positive	絕大多數正面	large majority	
overwhelmingly likely	極有可能	very high likelihood	

For your original sentence

> This change happened during my second year at university, when I was constantly
overwhelmed by deadlines, group projects, and part-time work.

Here:

overwhelmed = 各種期限、功課和兼職工作同時湧來，數量和壓力大到令我覺得自己根本應付不來

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當時我經常被截止日期、小組功課和兼職工作**壓得喘不過氣來**。

The useful contrast is:

> **busy** = 忙

> **stressed** = 有壓力

> **overwhelmed** = **事情多 / 壓力大到已經接近或超出自己的應付能力**

That stronger sense of overload is exactly what the passage is describing.